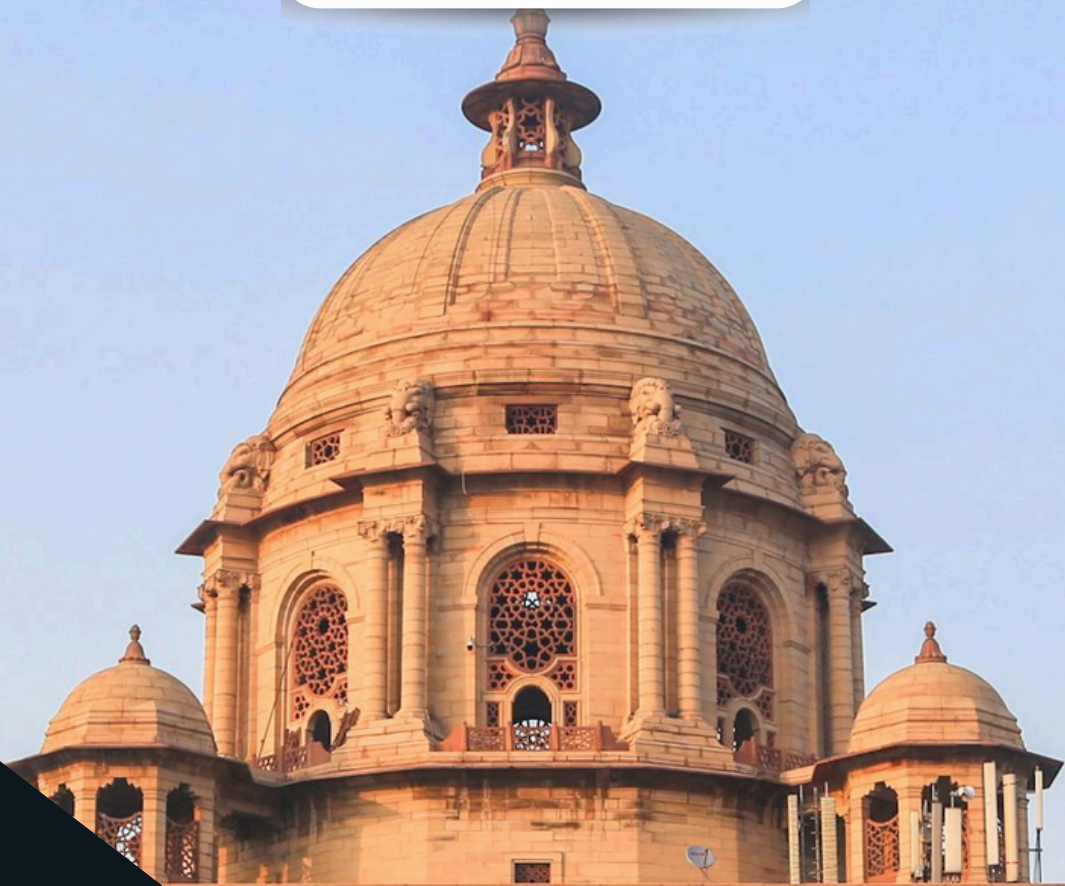




GS-2

(READYMADE - INTRODUCTION & CONCLUSIONS)

 **POWER-PACKED OPENERS & CLOSERS
(INFUSED WITH ARC RECOMMENDATIONS, SDGS,
KEY ARTICLES, LANDMARK SC JUDGMENTS,
SCHEMES, & GOVERNMENT TAGLINES)**

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GS-2: Readymade Introductions & Conclusions**Curated by XIAS for UPSC Mains – General Studies Paper II***“Good answers don’t just inform; they resonate.”*

This booklet provides **high-impact introductions and conclusions** across all subtopics of **GS Paper II – Indian Constitution, Polity, Governance & International Relations**, with:

- UPSC-relevant quotes and taglines
- Rich, thematic introductions reflecting constitutional and policy context
- Crisp, exam-friendly conclusions rooted in schemes, ARC reports, SDGs, Articles & SC judgments
- Current examples and frameworks aligned with **2024–25 trends**

Why This Booklet?

In UPSC Mains, the **first and last 30 seconds** of your answer shape impact. This booklet is designed to:

- Help you **stand out** with nuanced openers & closures
- Save time with **readymade phrases** and **reliable structure**
- Enhance value with **constitutional references, taglines, and schemes** like *“Nyay, not just Kanoon”, “Sahyog se Samriddhi”, “One India, Inclusive India”*

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GS Paper-2 syllabus - thematic subtopics wise**1. Indian Constitution & Polity****Subtopics:**

- Historical Underpinnings and Evolution of the Constitution
- Salient Features and Basic Structure of the Constitution
- Significant Provisions and Amendments
- Comparison with Constitutions of Other Countries
- Separation of Powers and Dispute Redressal Mechanisms
- Federal Structure: Centre-State Relations and Challenges
- Devolution of Powers to Local Governments
- Appointment and Functions of Constitutional Bodies
- Salient Features of the Representation of People's Act
- Role of Pressure Groups and Associations
- Ministries and Departments of the Government

2. Governance & Administration**Subtopics:**

- Structure and Functioning of Executive and Judiciary
- Parliament and State Legislatures: Powers and Functions
- Statutory, Regulatory, and Quasi-Judicial Bodies
- Governance, Transparency & Accountability
- E-Governance: Applications, Models, Successes and Challenges
- Citizens' Charters and Other Institutional Mechanisms
- Role of Civil Services in Democracy

3. Social Justice**Subtopics:**

- Welfare Schemes for Vulnerable Sections
- Constitutional and Institutional Measures for Vulnerable Groups
- Development & Management of Health, Education, Human Resources
- Issues Relating to Poverty and Hunger
- Development Industry: Role of NGOs, SHGs, and Other Stakeholders
- Government Policies and Implementation Challenges
- Gender Budgeting & Feminist Public Policy
- Transgender Rights & Inclusion
- Disability Rights and Accessibility
- Social Stock Exchange & Philanthropy in Welfare
- Digital Inclusion as a Social Equaliser
- Urban Poor and Informal Workers
- Child Welfare and Juvenile Justice
- Intersectionality in Social Justice
- Civic Tech in Welfare Delivery
- Social Capital and Community-Led Development

4. International Relations**Subtopics:**

- India and its Neighbourhood
- Bilateral, Regional and Global Groupings involving India
- Effect of Policies and Politics of Developed and Developing Countries
- Role of Indian Diaspora in Foreign Policy
- Important International Institutions: Structure and Mandates

GS-2 Topic 1: Indian Constitution & Polity

1. Historical Underpinnings and Evolution of the Constitution

Quote:

"Our Constitution is a testament to the sacrifices of generations who believed in justice, liberty, equality, and fraternity." — President Droupadi Murmu

Introduction:

A journey from the Regulating Act to Nehru's Objectives Resolution, India's constitutional arc mirrored its transformation from colonial command to participatory democracy, embodying the spirit of **"Raj se Samvidhan tak."**

Examples:

- Law Commission's consultation paper proposed integrating constitutional history in legal education reforms
- UGC rolled out 'Samvidhan Mahotsav' across universities
- NCERT revamped Class 12 Political Science with new Constitution-making modules

Conclusion:

Constitutional literacy must deepen beyond ceremonies into classrooms, civic tech, and citizen charters to make Samvidhan truly participative.

2. Salient Features and Basic Structure of the Constitution

Quote:

"The basic structure is the North Star of Indian democracy." — Justice D.Y. Chandrachud

Introduction:

Rooted in the ideals of liberty, equality, and fraternity, the Indian Constitution upholds **"Nyay, not just Kanoon,"** with its basic structure ensuring that democratic continuity outlasts political churn.

Examples:

- SC struck down electoral bonds citing violation of voters' right to information
- Parliamentary Committee reaffirmed secularism as core to electoral reforms
- ARC-II emphasized constitutional morality as non-negotiable for institutional integrity

Conclusion:

India's basic structure doctrine protects not tradition, but transformation with dignity, dissent, and democracy as its sentinels.

3. Significant Provisions and Amendments

Quote:

"Amendment is the lifeline of a living Constitution." — Nani Palkhivala

Introduction:

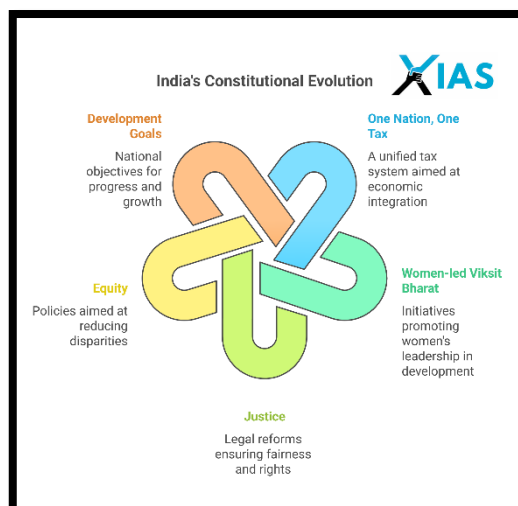
India's constitutional amendments from **"One Nation, One Tax"** to **women-led Viksit Bharat** demonstrate dynamic adaptation to justice, equity, and development goals.

Examples:

- 106th Amendment enabled 33% reservation for women in legislatures
- NITI Aayog proposed fiscal federalism reforms via constitutional amendment
- SC upheld EWS quota as a reasonable classification under Art. 15(6)

Conclusion:

Amendments must be tools of inclusion, not instruments of



impulse guided by reason, data, and the Constitution's spirit of justice.

4. Comparison with Constitutions of Other Countries

Quote:

"While we borrowed from many, we built for Bharat." — Dr. B.R. Ambedkar

Introduction:

A unique blend of global constitutional wisdom, **India's constitutional design marries UK's parliamentary ethics, US's checks-and-balances, and Irish DPSPs to craft a Bharatiya model.**

Examples:

- Law Commission proposed selective adoption of AI laws from EU
- SC cited US Supreme Court precedents in digital privacy verdict
- NITI Aayog referenced OECD models for cooperative federalism

Conclusion:

Learning globally but acting locally keeps Indian constitutionalism adaptive and culturally rooted.

5. Separation of Powers and Dispute Redressal Mechanisms

Quote:

"No organ can claim supremacy, only harmony." — Justice R.F. Nariman

Introduction:

India's democracy is safeguarded by a calibrated separation of powers, where checks and balances ensure that **Samvaad, not Sangharsh**, defines institutional relations.

Examples:

- SC ruling upheld tribunal independence in GST Appellate Tribunal setup
- Lokpal released its first digital annual report
- Ministry of Law proposed mediation bill reforms

Conclusion:

Checks and balances need constant tuning to preserve constitutional equilibrium.

6. Federal Structure: Centre-State Relations and Challenges

Quote:

"Cooperative federalism is not a choice; it is a constitutional compulsion." — PM Narendra Modi

Introduction:

With platforms like NITI Aayog and PM Gati Shakti, India's federal spirit is evolving from confrontation to convergence, ensuring **"One India, Inclusive India."**

Examples:

- Finance Commission flagged GST compensation delays
- Inter-State Council revived with new agenda
- MoHUA enabled urban funds linked to SDG localisation

Conclusion:

India's unity will depend on **"Sahyog se Samriddhi"**, not just legal boundaries but fiscal trust and cooperative temperament.

7. Devolution of Powers to Local Governments

Quote:

"Democracy at the grassroots is democracy at its strongest." — Mahatma Gandhi

Introduction:

From digital panchayats to urban devolution-linked SDGs, India is giving shape to **Jan Bhagidari se Jan Governance** making decentralisation more than tokenism.

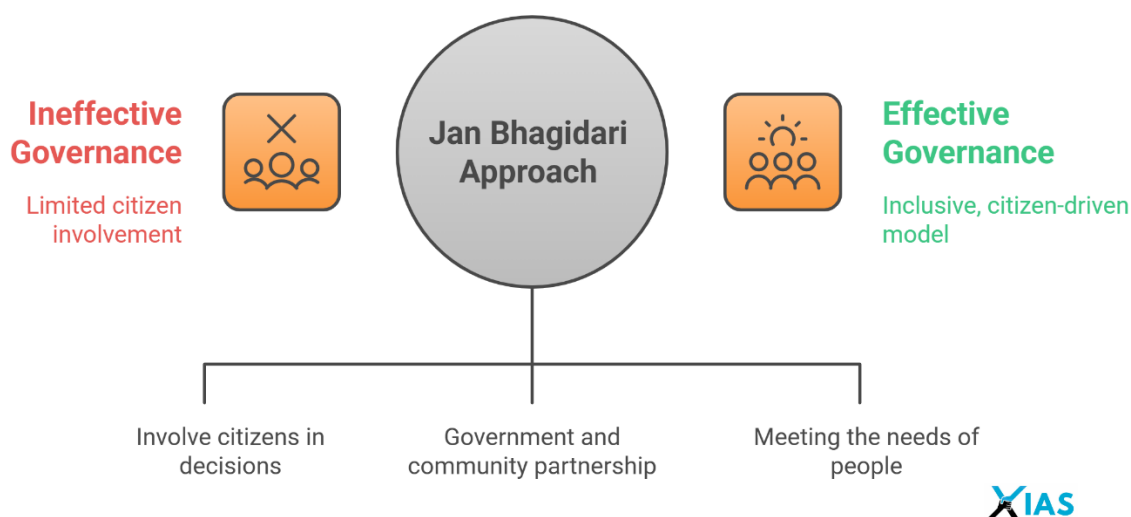
Examples:

- MoPR launched e-GramSwaraj 2.0 with spatial planning tools



- MoHUA tied urban devolution funds to service-level benchmarks
- 15th Finance Commission incentivised performance-based panchayat grants

Public Participation Enhances Governance



Conclusion:

Strong democracies grow bottom-up by building institutions that localise delivery, voice, and accountability.

8. Appointment and Functions of Constitutional Bodies

Quote:

"Autonomy without accountability is as dangerous as control without competence." — Second ARC

Introduction:

Institutions like EC, CAG and UPSC require transparent appointments and performance-driven autonomy to sustain public faith in India's constitutional ecosystem.

Examples:

- SC laid down new guidelines for EC appointments
- CAG reports digitised under One Nation Audit Grid
- Parliamentary Committee flagged delays in CIC appointments

Conclusion:

Autonomous bodies must combine insulation with transparency—preserving trust in institutions that guard the Constitution.

9. Salient Features of the Representation of People's Act

Quote:

"The essence of democracy is free and fair elections." — S.Y. Quraishi

Introduction:

The RP Act continues to evolve in the digital age grappling with issues of electoral bonds, voter portability and criminalisation while safeguarding public faith in elections.

Examples:

- SC struck down electoral bonds scheme
- EC proposed remote voting prototype for migrant citizens
- Law Commission suggested synchronised polls under RP Act framework

Conclusion:

India's electoral laws must evolve to match voter empowerment and clean politics in the digital age.

10. Role of Pressure Groups and Associations**Quote:**

"In democracy, even silence can organise into influence." — Granville Austin

Introduction:

A gradual shift from farmer unions to digital advocacy groups, informal networks shape policy expanding democracy from *Jan Andolan* to *Jan Nirnay*.

Examples:

- NCW worked with CSOs for anti-cyberbullying framework
- Startup associations influenced DPIIT's regulatory sandbox policies
- Farmers' collectives engaged with MSP reform committee

Conclusion:

Democracy thrives when institutions listen beyond offices to voices in forums, movements, and feedback platforms.

11. Ministries and Departments of the Government**Quote:**

"A government is only as good as its coordination." — NITI Aayog Strategy Document

Introduction:

Ride from **Viksit Bharat Sankalp Yatra** to integrated dashboards, ministries are moving from **silos to synergy**, enabling evidence-based governance and citizen-centric service delivery.

Examples:

- MEITY integrated grievance redress with CPGRAMS 3.0
- MoLE linked e-Shram with PM-SVANidhi database
- MoSPI aligned ministry KPIs with SDG targets

Conclusion:

Seamless service delivery demands convergence—of data, design, and development thinking across ministries.

GS-2 Topic 2: Governance, Transparency & Accountability**1. Government Policies and Interventions for Development****Quote:**

"Policies must not only target growth, but must also engineer inclusion." — Amartya Sen

Introduction:

Path from Jan Dhan to Jal Jeevan, government interventions have evolved from entitlement delivery to mission-mode outcomes embodying *Antyodaya* and **"Minimum Government, Maximum Governance"** through tech-driven, targeted schemes.

Examples:

- NITI Aayog released '**Viksit Bharat @2047**' policy vision documents
- MoRD upgraded DAY-NRLM with AI-powered monitoring
- MoHFW launched dashboard for PM-ABHIM convergence

Conclusion:

Development policy must pivot from expenditure to empowerment—backed by citizen data, local feedback, and outcomes, not outlays.

2. Development Processes and the Development Industry**Quote:**

"Development is a partnership not charity."



Introduction:

NGOs, SHGs, and CSOs are no longer peripheral they're **last-mile multipliers**, increasingly integrated into schemes like Aspirational Blocks Programme and Mission Antyodaya for community-led governance.

Examples:

- MoRD partnered NGOs for cluster facilitation in SHG schemes
- FSSAI engaged CSOs in Eat Right India campaign
- Tribal Ministry scaled Van Dhan Vikas Kendras through SHGs

Conclusion:

When civil society and state co-create, development becomes durable, inclusive, and democratic—from policy drafting to service delivery.

3. Welfare Schemes for Vulnerable Sections**Quote:**

"The test of good governance is how it treats its weakest citizens." — Mahatma Gandhi

Introduction:

Be it SC/ST scholarships or PM-Vishwakarma, India's welfare focus has shifted from identity alone to intersectionality merging social justice with skill, dignity, and digital access.

Examples:

- MoTA digitised scholarship disbursement via DBT stack
- MoLE launched gig worker welfare registry pilot
- MoWCD expanded Sakhi One-Stop Centres

Conclusion:

Empowerment lies not in benefits alone but in building capability, choice, and dignity for the most marginalised.

4. Issues Relating to Social Sector—Health, Education, Human Resources**Quote:**

"Human development is the true index of national strength." — UNDP HDR

Introduction:

Health and education are no longer welfare add-ons they're strategic investments, now steered by Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and NEP 2020 for holistic human capital.

Examples:

- MoE rolled out UDISE+ AI dashboard for learning outcomes
- MoHFW scaled digital health IDs under ABDM
- NITI Aayog launched National Health Stack Sandbox

Conclusion:

Transforming people into productive citizens needs convergence of welfare, workforce planning, and digital public goods.

5. Issues Relating to Poverty and Hunger**Quote:**

"Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere." — ILO Declaration



Introduction:

From targeted PDS to Poshan Tracker, poverty policy is moving beyond calorie count towards *nutrition security, asset access*, and dignity of living.

Examples:

- NFSA portal integrated with Aadhaar seeding and real-time ration tracking
- MoWCD updated Poshan Tracker with regional dashboards
- SECC data revision initiated for better poverty targeting

Conclusion:

Eradicating poverty isn't just about income uplift it's about giving citizens a platform for mobility, dignity, and resilience.

6. Governance, Transparency & E-Governance**Quote:**

"Transparency is the currency of trust in governance." — Second ARC

Introduction:

E-Governance is reshaping India's statecraft from *file-notings to facial recognition*, with CPGRAMS 3.0, DigiLocker, and UMANG leading citizen-state connectivity.

Examples:

- MEITY deployed AI grievance analysis in CPGRAMS 3.0
- MoSPI integrated dashboards with SDG progress
- Ministry of Coal launched drone-based mine monitoring portal

Conclusion:

Governance must now mean visibility, verifiability, and velocity where citizen trust is earned through tech-enabled accountability.

7. Role of Civil Services in Democracy**Quote:**

"Civil servants are the steel frame but must also be the spinal nerve of reform." — Sardar Patel

Introduction:

With **Mission Karmayogi** and **iGOT 2.0**, civil services are transitioning **from rule-based to role-based** focusing on behavioural change, citizen empathy, and real-time delivery.

Examples:

- DoPT launched AI-enabled iGOT Karmayogi learning pathways
- Capacity Building Commission released departmental capacity scorecards
- DARPG piloted Mission Karmayogi in UTs and North-East

Conclusion:

Civil services must lead change not just implement it blending empathy, ethics, and efficiency in public service.

Topic 3: Social Justice**1. Welfare Schemes for Vulnerable Sections****Quote:**

"The test of our progress is not whether we add to the abundance of those who have much, but whether we provide enough for those who have little." – Franklin D. Roosevelt

Introduction:

Targeted welfare today is not just about doles but dignity via DBT, JAM trinity, and saturation-based coverage under "Antyodaya to Atmanirbharta." The social contract now runs through digital rails and grassroots reach.

Examples:

- MoSJ&E expanded UDID portal with real-time scheme convergence for PwDs
- MoTA integrated Van Dhan Yojana with ONDC for tribal market access

- Rural Development Ministry geo-tagged PMAY-G assets to reduce leakages

Conclusion:

Welfare must evolve into empowerment rooted in rights, refined by tech, and responsive to voices from the margins.

2. Constitutional and Institutional Measures for Vulnerable Groups

Quote:

"The Constitution is a transformative document it enshrines not charity but rights." – Justice Indu Malhotra

Introduction:

Institutional justice is delivered not just in courts but in commissions, reservations, and rights-based legislations that breathe life into **Articles 15, 16, 17, and 39**. The challenge now lies in credible enforcement.

Examples:

- NCBC flagged irregularities in creamy layer implementation across states
- NCPCR partnered with NALSA on juvenile justice capacity-building
- SC upheld 10% EWS quota citing reasonable classification under Art. 15(6)

Conclusion:

Laws without empathy and institutions without teeth serve neither equity nor efficiency. Accountability must drive the rights architecture forward.



3. Development & Management of Health, Education, and Human Resources

Quote:

"An educated, healthy population is not a burden it is the foundation of any civilised society." – Amartya Sen

Introduction:

Health and education now define not just HDI, but national competitiveness. NEP 2020 and Ayushman Bharat mark a shift from input-based models to outcome-led, equity-centered human capital strategies.

Examples:

- NMC implemented guidelines for family physicians under Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission
- NCERT launched National Mission for Foundational Literacy and Numeracy
- NTA introduced regional language parity for CUET to improve inclusivity

Conclusion:

Human capital must be nurtured as a public good—through universal access, inclusive quality, and responsive innovation.

4. Issues Relating to Poverty and Hunger

Quote:

"Poverty is the worst form of violence." – Mahatma Gandhi

Introduction:

India's tryst with poverty now hinges on multidimensionality beyond income to health, nutrition, dignity, and access. The journey from food security to nutrition security needs policy stamina and community ownership.

Examples:

- NITI Aayog released Multidimensional Poverty Index showing major rural improvements
- MoWCD digitised ICDS under Poshan Tracker with real-time nutrition dashboards

- NFSA coverage updated using Aadhaar-enabled dynamic exclusion

Conclusion:

Hunger must end not with handouts, but with holistic dignity through data-led targeting and nutrition-sensitive development.

5. Development Industry: Role of NGOs, SHGs, and Other Stakeholders**Quote:**

"The development sector is not third sector it is the frontline of inclusive governance." – Abhijit Banerjee

Introduction:

SHGs as engines of rural finance to NGOs as policy bridges, the “samaj sarkar bazaar” triad now shapes last-mile development. Trust and transparency define the legitimacy of this development ecosystem.

Examples:

- DAY-NRLM linked SHG product sales with GeM portal
- NITI Aayog released voluntary sector index to rank NGO governance
- MoTA engaged NGOs under FRA capacity-building in forest villages

Conclusion:

Stakeholder-led governance thrives when regulation empowers and partnerships democratise delivery—from tokenism to trust.

6. Government Policies and Implementation Challenges**Quote:**

"Good policies fail with bad implementation; bad policies fail faster." – Second ARC

Introduction:

India's policy architecture is increasingly ambitious—Digital India, Skill India, Swachh Bharat—but delivery lags stem from fragmented coordination, capacity gaps, and evaluation blind spots.

Examples:

- PRAGATI flagged inter-ministerial delays in housing convergence
- CAG found fund diversion in rural skilling under DDU-GKY
- NeGD launched unified digital dashboards for scheme tracking

Conclusion:

Implementation must become the new reform through capacity audits, citizen feedback loops, and fiscal accountability.

7. Gender Budgeting & Feminist Public Policy**Quote:**

"A budget tells us what we value as a society." — UN Women

Introduction:

Gender budgeting isn't about separate allocations for women it's about shaping public finance through the lens of Article 15(3) and SDG 5, ensuring schemes like **Beti Bachao Beti Padhao** and **Mission Shakti** reflect real inclusion, not tokenism.

Examples:

- Ministry of Finance issued revised Gender Budget Statement 2024 with performance tracking
- State Gender Budget Cells activated in Rajasthan and Tamil Nadu
- NITI Aayog's Women's Economic Empowerment Dashboard launched for gender-sensitive planning

Conclusion:

Empowered women drive inclusive GDP—gender budgeting must shift from form to force in policymaking.

8. Transgender Rights & Inclusion**Quote:**

"Everyone has the right to be who they are, without apology." — Supreme Court (NALSA, 2014)

Introduction:

Transgender justice is more than legal recognition—it's social acceptance through rights, dignity, and delivery. Acts like the Transgender Protection Act and schemes like SMILE move us closer to *Nyay, not just Kanoon*.

Examples:

- Garima Greh shelter homes expanded to all state capitals
- National Portal for Transgender Persons enabled self-ID and benefits access
- UGC mandated trans-inclusion policies in all central universities

Conclusion:

Trans justice must move from margins to mainstream—led by empathy in law, equity in policy.

9. Disability Rights and Accessibility**Quote:**

"Inclusion is not a favor, it's a constitutional promise." — RPwD Act, 2016

Introduction:

True accessibility lies in making **Article 41 and SDG 10** operational through accessible infrastructure, digital tools, and equal opportunity ensuring **India's 2.2% disabled population lives with dignity, not dependency**.

Examples:

- Sugamya Bharat App integrated grievance redress for disabled
- UDI (Unique Disability ID) platform made Aadhaar-compliant
- SC directed accessible exam formats for visually impaired UPSC aspirants

Conclusion:

Disability inclusion must rise from assistance to agency enabling full societal participation.

Great! Continuing in the same rich and attractive UPSC-ready tone, here are the next **three micro-topics** under

10. Social Stock Exchange & Philanthropy in Welfare**Quote:**

"Markets can fund change when trust meets transparency." — SEBI Chairperson

Introduction:

The Social Stock Exchange (SSE) bridges capital and compassion transforming CSR into community impact and aligning with SDG 17 on partnerships and Article 38's directive for social justice.

Examples:

- SEBI accredited first Not-for-Profit Organizations (NPOs) under SSE in Mumbai
- CSR 2.0 guidelines aligned disclosure norms with SSE framework
- Ministry of Corporate Affairs launched impact reporting standards for social enterprises

Conclusion:

Philanthropy must become structured, scalable, and strategic SSE is India's leap toward finance with a conscience.

11. Digital Inclusion as a Social Equaliser**Quote:**

"Bridging the digital divide is the new freedom struggle." — PM's Digital India Mission

Introduction:

Digital inclusion isn't just tech access it's about dismantling caste, gender, and rural divides in opportunity. Article 21A's right to education and SDG 9 (industry, innovation, infrastructure) converge in schemes like PM-WANI and BharatNet.

Examples:

- MoE launched National Digital University targeting underserved learners



- MeitY expanded PMGDISHA (Digital Literacy Mission) to remote blocks
- UDISE+ data integrated internet access indicators in school rankings

Conclusion:

Tech is the new tool of social mobility digital Bharat must mean dignified Bharat.

12. Urban Poor and Informal Workers**Quote:**

"Cities must work for the ones who build them." — UN-Habitat

Introduction:

The urban poor, powering India's growth, face structural exclusion livelihood schemes under DAY-NULM and rights under Article 43 must translate to stable housing, health, and dignity for informal workers and migrant labour.

Examples:

- MoHUA linked PM SVANidhi with skilling under Skill India Mission
- e-Shram database integrated with insurance under PMSBY
- NITI Aayog's gig economy report recommended social security code implementation

Conclusion:

A resilient India must build cities for all not just smart cities, but just cities.

Here are the next set of micro-topics under **GS-2 Topic 3: Social Justice**, continuing the same UPSC-ready tone with rich introductions, specific examples, and impactful conclusions:

13. Child Welfare and Juvenile Justice**Quote:**

"Every child we fail is a future we weaken." — UN CRC Framework

Introduction:

Child welfare is the litmus test of a just society. Anchored in Article 39(e)(f), Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act and SDG 16.2 (end abuse, exploitation) together shape India's child-centric legal architecture.

Examples:

- NCPCR launched Baal Swaraj portal for tracking orphaned and abandoned children
- MWCD integrated Child Helpline 1098 with Emergency Response Support System (ERSS)
- Juvenile Justice Act amended to streamline role of DMs in child adoption

Conclusion:

Justice for children must be preventive, rehabilitative, and rights-based—not just a system, but a safety net.

14. Intersectionality in Social Justice**Quote:**

"Justice is not blind it must be deeply seeing." — Kimberlé Crenshaw

Introduction:

Social justice cannot be one-dimensional. Caste, gender, disability, and region intersect to deepen marginalisation. Article 15 and SDG 10 (reduce inequalities) demand policy lenses that are layered, not linear.

Examples:

- Transgender persons included in Ayushman Bharat coverage
- SC directive ensured hostel access for disabled women in public universities
- NITI Aayog advocated intersectional approach in nutrition strategy

Conclusion:

True justice isn't uniform it is tailored to complexity, designed for inclusion.

15. Civic Tech and Welfare Delivery**Quote:**

"Digital is not the end; dignity is." — Digital India Vision Document

Introduction:

From e-Shram to CoWIN, civic tech is revolutionising last-mile welfare. Bridging Aadhaar-based identity with DBT and grievance portals, it embodies Article 41's call for effective public assistance.

Examples:

- CPGRAMS 3.0 integrated AI-based redressal in 10 central ministries
- UMANG 2.0 added 1,500 new citizen service modules
- Anuvadini AI enabled real-time multilingual access in social schemes

Conclusion:

Tech must amplify trust digital infrastructure should empower the most invisible first.

16. Social Capital and Community-Led Development**Quote:**

"Communities are not beneficiaries they are architects of change." — Ministry of Rural Development

Introduction:

From SHGs to community kitchens, India's welfare landscape thrives when people co-create outcomes. Articles 40 & 243 and SDG 11 (inclusive communities) underline the strength of decentralised, participatory models.

Examples:

- DAY-NRLM mobilised 9 crore SHG women for nutrition and sanitation drives
- Aspirational Blocks Programme adopted localised metrics through community dashboards
- Ministry of Tribal Affairs promoted Van Dhan Vikas Kendras as community enterprises

Conclusion:

When communities lead, governance transforms from delivery to dignity.

GS-2 Topic 4: International Relations**1. India and its Neighbourhood****Quote:**

"A nation's destiny is shaped by its geography but defined by its diplomacy." — Shyam Saran

Introduction:

In an era of geoeconomics and geostrategy, India's neighbourhood policy is shifting from passive proximity to proactive partnership. Guided by **Neighbourhood First, SAGAR and Act East**, India seeks a stable periphery to anchor its global ambitions in an increasingly Indo-Pacific-centric world order.

Examples:

- India hosted the BIMSTEC Security Dialogue focusing on regional counter-terrorism
- e-VBAB (Tele-education) initiative extended to Sri Lanka under digital diplomacy
- PM's Bhutan visit yielded MoUs on energy grid cooperation and space tech

Conclusion:

Neighbourhood ties need not just history but harmony, resilience, and regionalism rooted in shared prosperity.

2. Bilateral, Regional and Global Groupings involving India**Quote:**

"Strategic autonomy is not strategic isolation it is meaningful multialignment." — S. Jaishankar

Introduction:

India's ascent as a **Vishwa Mitra** hinges on dynamic bilateralism and purposeful multilateralism. From Quad's Indo-Pacific pivot to BRICS+ reform, India is recalibrating groupings not just for voice but for value, norms, and strategic hedging in a fluid global architecture.

Examples:

- India chaired the Global South Summit to amplify LDC voices
- BRICS accepted new members with India pushing for expansion balance
- India and EU relaunched FTA negotiations under Trade and Tech Council

Conclusion:

India's group diplomacy must balance aspirations with agility where global stakes meet national interest.

3. Effect of Policies and Politics of Developed and Developing Countries on India's Interests**Quote:**

"In a globalised world, even sovereignty is influenced by decisions abroad." — Foreign Policy White Paper

Introduction:

In a polycrisis world, decisions in Washington, Brussels or Beijing reverberate in New Delhi. Be it digital protectionism, tech decoupling, or climate finance, India must decode global shifts and align interests with agility, sovereignty, and strategic depth.

Examples:

- EU's CBAM policy raised India's carbon trade concerns
- US CHIPS Act prompted India's semiconductor collaboration push
- China's rare-earth export control spurred India-Australia critical minerals pact

Conclusion:

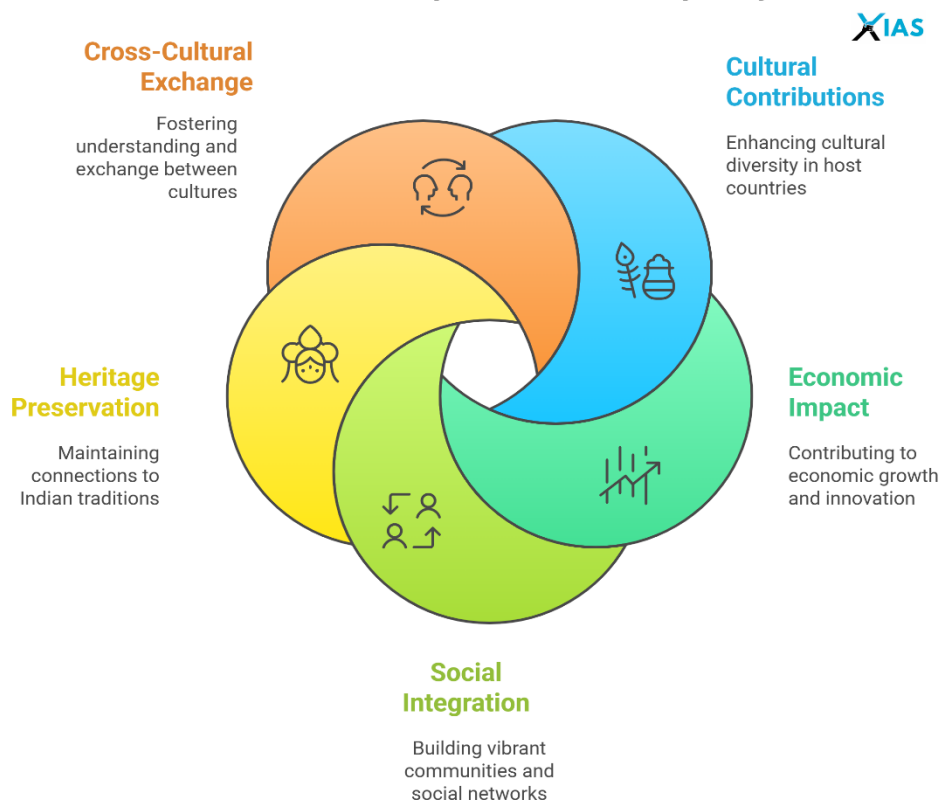
India's external strategy must combine foresight with resilience to shield sovereignty while shaping the global commons.

4. Role of Indian Diaspora in Foreign Policy**Quote:**

"Our diaspora is not just an asset it is an amplifier of Bharat's soft power." — PM Narendra Modi

Introduction:

The Indian diaspora is no longer just a bridge it's a **lever of diplomacy, technology transfer, and narrative-shaping**. From Silicon Valley boardrooms to Gulf labor corridors, overseas Indians are now strategic stakeholders in India's foreign engagement matrix.

The Indian Diaspora: A Global Tapestry

Examples:

- Pravasi Bharatiya Divas launched the Global Diaspora Startup Connect
- India-UAE labour mobility pact digitised welfare for blue-collar workers
- Diaspora diplomacy enabled faster evacuation from Sudan (Operation Kaveri)

Conclusion:

Engaging the diaspora must transcend celebration into co-creation of India's global aspirations.

5. Important International Institutions: Structure and Mandates**Quote:**

"Global governance must evolve or it will erode." — Antonio Guterres

Introduction:

The post-war multilateral order faces a legitimacy deficit. As India aspires for *Viksit Bharat@2047*, its push for institutional reform from UNSC to WTO seeks to democratise global governance, ensuring that "rules-based order" is not code for status-quoism.

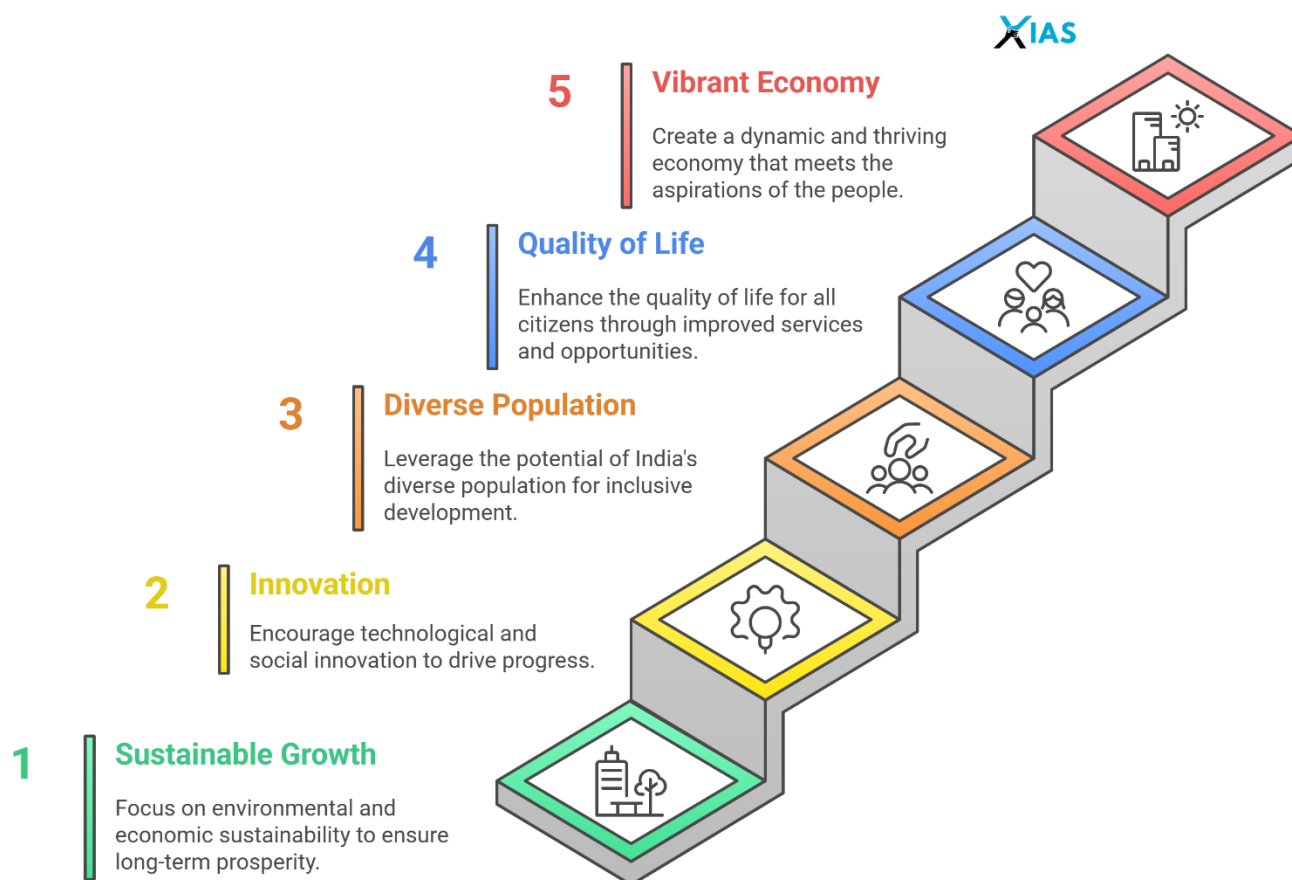
Examples:

- India backed Global Digital Public Infrastructure Framework at G20
- UN Security Council reform pitch revived at South Summit chaired by India
- WTO negotiations saw India defend Global South on agricultural subsidies

Conclusion:

Reimagining institutions is not disruption it's inclusion, ensuring equity in global rule-making.

Journey to Viksit Bharat 2047



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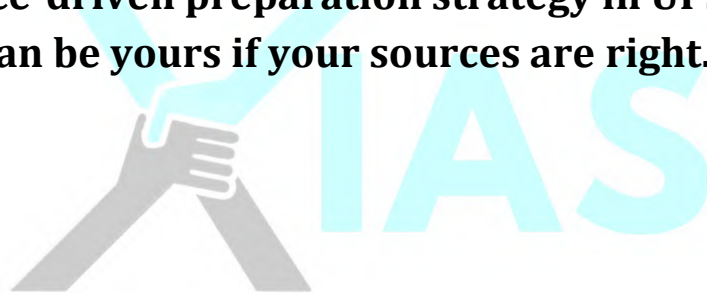
"The difference between a topper and an average aspirant is not effort it's direction."

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14. Who among the following rulers in ancient India had assumed the titles 'Mattavilasa', 'Vichitrachitta' and 'Udayabhara'?

- (a) Mahendravarmā I
(b) Simhavishnu
(c) Narasimhavarmā I
(d) Simhavarmā

XIAS
LEVEL-1 RTS
Class Notes
X Lecture

Mahendravarmā I was a follower of Jainism in the early part of his career. He was converted to Saivism by the influence of the Saiva saint, Thirunavukarasar alias Appar. He built a Siva temple at Tiruvadi. He assumed a number of titles like Gunabhara, Suryasandha, Chettakani (builder of temples) Chitrakarapuli, Vichitrachitta and Mattavilasa.

He ruled from Tamralipti (port @ BoBengal) and Amaravati to Burma, and Indonesia. The ports of south India sent ships to Tenasserim, Trang, Malacca, and Java.

The ancient capital of Thailand was named after Ayodhya.

He performed various Vedic sacrifices, including the Ashvamedha.

A later group of Pallava rulers, Mahendra-varman I (600-630) was. He was a contemporary of Thanesar and curiously enough was also a dramatist and poet, of some being the author of a play, *Mattavilasa-prahasana* (The Delight of the

It was during his reign that some of the finest rock-cut Pallava temples, including the famous temples at Mahabalipuram. Mahendra-varman began

Jaina but was converted to Shaivism by the saint Appar. Mahendra-varman's

ty was Pulakeshin II.

varman swept right into the capital of Badami and his occupation of the city

claim to the title of *Vatapikonda*, 'the Conqueror of Vatapi'.

varman's play *Mattavilasa* was well-known and frequently performed by the actors of

→ RTS LEVEL-2

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13. The irrigation device called 'Araghatta' was

- (a) a water bag made of leather pulled over a pulley
(b) a large wheel with earthen pots tied to the outer ends of its spokes
(c) a larger earthen pot driven by bullocks
(d) a large water bucket pulled up by rope directly by hand

Whether the Persian wheel was in use in early medieval Rajasthan is debated, and hinges on the interpretation of the term *araghatta*. The key issue is whether the reference is to the Persian wheel or to the *noria*. The *noria* is a wheel which has pots or buckets attached to its rim without a chain for carrying the pots, or a gear mechanism to ensure continuous flow of water. It could only be used to draw water from close to the surface or from a river.



→ Explained in details in BTS class (LEVEL-2)

The Persian wheel, on the other hand, had gears and a chain to carry the pots and was associated with a well. *araghatta* seems to have been different from an ordinary well (*dhimada*) or a step well (*vapi*). UPSC PYQ.

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6. Consider the following statements :

I. India has joined the Minerals Security Partnership as a member.

II. India is a resource-rich country in all the 30 critical minerals that it has identified.

III. The Parliament in 2023 has amended the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957 empowering the Central Government to exclusively auction mining lease and composite license for certain critical minerals.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and II only (b) II and III only
(c) I and III only (d) I, II and III

MINERALS SECURITY PARTNERSHIP FINANCE NETWORK

Recent Update: India joined the US-led Minerals Security Partnership (MSP) Finance Network to secure sustainable critical mineral supply chains.

About:

- Global Collaboration: Joint financing body for critical mineral projects worldwide.
- Objectives: Strengthen Indo-Pacific and European cooperation for sustainable supply chains.
- Critical Minerals: Includes lithium, cobalt, nickel, and rare earth elements crucial for modern technologies.

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9. Consider the following statements :

Statement I :

Circular economy reduces the emissions of greenhouse gases.

Statement II :

Circular economy reduces the use of raw materials as inputs.

Statement III :

Circular economy reduces wastage in the production process.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

- (a) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct and both of them explain Statement I
(b) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct but only one of them explains Statement I
(c) Only one of the Statements II and III is correct and that explains Statement I
(d) Neither Statement II nor Statement III is correct

XIAS
Current X-press
Magazine

VOLUNTARY VEHICLE MODERNIZATION PROGRAM

Recent Update: Union Ministry of Road Transport and Highways launched the Vehicle Scrapping Policy

to promote a circular economy in the automotive sector.

About:

- Circular Economy: Aims to reduce raw material consumption and encourage recycling.
- Scrappage Certificate: Provided to owners of unfit vehicles to avail discounts on new purchases.
- Incentives: Discounts of up to 3% for commercial vehicles and 1.5% for passenger vehicles on ex-showroom prices.

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83. Consider the following space missions :

I. Axiom-4

II. SpaDeX

III. Gaganyaan

How many of the space missions given above encourage and support micro-gravity research?

- (a) Only one (b) Only two
(c) All the three (d) None

GAGANYAAN MISSION

Recent Update: ISRO has selected Gaganyaan astronauts to travel to the International Space Station (ISS) on the Axiom-4 mission, scheduled for October 2024. The mission will be a collaboration with NASA and Axiom Space, utilizing SpaceX's Dragon spacecraft.

About:

- Mission Details: The astronauts will undergo training in the US before the mission.
- Collaboration: India's space program cooperates with NASA and Axiom Space.
- Gaganyaan: India's first human space mission is expected post-2025, after successful uncrewed missions.

AXIOM MISSION 4 (AX-4)

Recent Update: Shubhanshu Shukla and Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair Selected for Axiom-4 mission.

About:

- AX-4: Fourth private astronaut mission to the International Space Station (ISS).
- Duration: 14 days.
- Launch Provider: SpaceX.

SPADEX MISSION

Recent Update: India's SpaDeX mission will demonstrate spacecraft docking technology using PSLV-C50 on December 30.

About SpaDeX Mission:

- What it is: A technology demonstrator for spacecraft docking developed by ISRO.
- Objectives:
 - Primary: Demonstrate rendezvous, docking, and undocking.
 - Secondary: Power transfer between docked spacecraft.
- Technologies:
 - Docking system: Low-impact androgynous.

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48. With reference to monoclonal antibodies, often mentioned in news, consider the following statements :

- I. They are man-made proteins.
- II. They stimulate immunological function due to their ability to bind to specific antigens.
- III. They are used in treating viral infections like that of Nipah virus.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and II only
- (b) II and III only
- (c) I and III only
- (d) I, II and III

MONOCLONAL ANTIBODIES

Recent Update: Monoclonal antibodies (mAbs) continue to be widely used in diagnostics, treatments, and cell analysis, offering targeted therapies for diseases like cancer and autoimmune disorders.

About:

- Monoclonal antibodies (mAbs) are lab-made proteins designed to mimic natural antibodies.
- Antibodies are part of the immune system, targeting and destroying foreign materials (antigens).
- Key applications include:
 1. Diagnostics (e.g., ELISA),
 2. Treating diseases such as cancer, infections, and autoimmune disorders,
 3. Cell analysis in blood/tissue using fluorescent tags.

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24. Consider the following statements about turmeric during the year 2022-23 :

- I. India is the largest producer and exporter of turmeric in the world.
- II. More than 30 varieties of turmeric are grown in India.
- III. Maharashtra, Telangana, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu are major turmeric producing States in India.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) I and II only
- (b) II and III only
- (c) I and III only
- (d) I, II and III

NATIONAL TURMERIC BOARD ESTABLISHED

Recent Update: The National Turmeric Board has been launched to support turmeric production and export.

About:

- Objectives: Farmer welfare, R&D, export promotion, quality control.
- India's Dominance: Produces 70% of the world's turmeric.
- Key Regions: Maharashtra, Telangana, Meghalaya.

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96. Which organization has enacted the Nature Restoration Law (NRL) to tackle climate change and biodiversity loss?

- (a) The European Union
- (b) The World Bank
- (c) The Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development
- (d) The Food and Agriculture Organization

EU NATURE RESTORATION LAW

Recent Update: The EU Nature Restoration Law has come into force.

About:

- First continent-wide legislation for nature restoration.
- Targets to restore 20% of degraded ecosystems by 2030, and 100% by 2050.
- Member States must prepare National Restoration Plans by 1st September 2026.
- Legally binding targets:
 - 30% of terrestrial, coastal, freshwater, and marine ecosystems to be restored by 2030.
 - 25,000 km of rivers to be restored to free-flowing status by 2030.
 - Plant three billion trees by 2030.

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30. Consider the following statements about the Rashtriya Gokul Mission :

- I. It is important for the upliftment of rural poor as majority of low producing indigenous animals are with small and marginal farmers and landless labourers.
- II. It was initiated to promote indigenous cattle and buffalo rearing and conservation in a scientific and holistic manner.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

RASHTRIYA GOKUL MISSION

Recent Update:

The Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying highlighted the Rashtriya Gokul Mission (RGM) for indigenous bovine conservation and milk production.

About:

- RGM was launched in 2014 as part of the Rashtriya Pashudhan Vikas Yojna with a budget of Rs. 1400 crore (2021-2026).
- Aims to conserve indigenous bovine breeds like Punganur for climate resilience and high-quality milk production.
- Focuses on increasing genetic diversity, supporting Artificial Insemination (AI), and conservation efforts.
- Introduces National Digital Livestock Mission to enhance data management and services.

88. Consider the following statements :

- I. If any question arises as to whether a Member of the House of the People has become subject to disqualification under the 10th Schedule, the President's decision in accordance with the opinion of the Council of Union Ministers shall be final.
- II. There is no mention of the word 'political party' in the Constitution of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

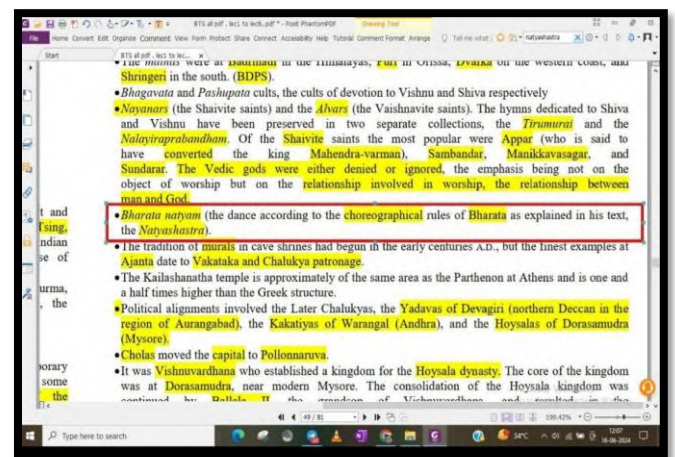
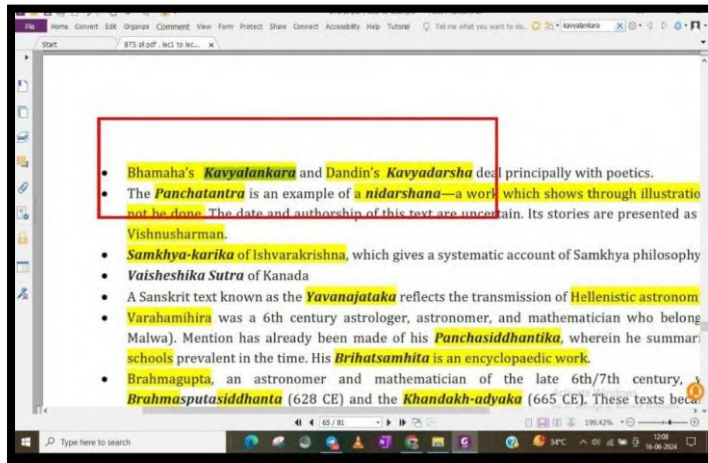
- (a) I only
- (b) II only
- (c) Both I and II
- (d) Neither I nor II

POWERS OF SPEAKER

- The Speaker, elected by a simple majority, has a key constitutional role, including overseeing the House, casting votes, and dealing with member disqualification.
- The Speaker has vast powers in conducting the House, deciding on questions, expunging remarks, and ensuring impartiality in procedures.
- The Speaker's casting vote resolves tie votes, typically favoring the government.

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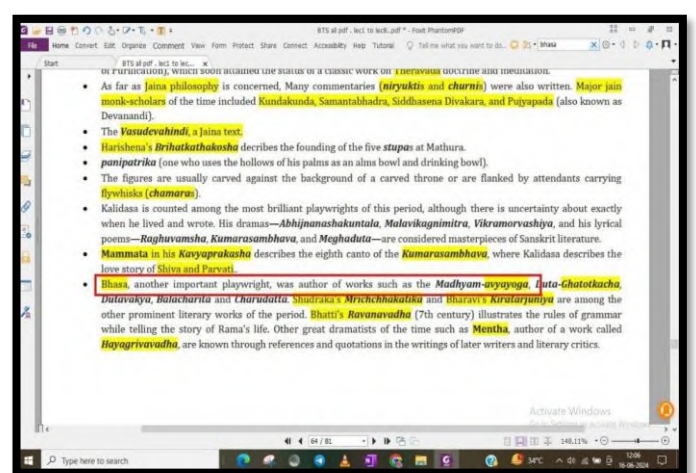
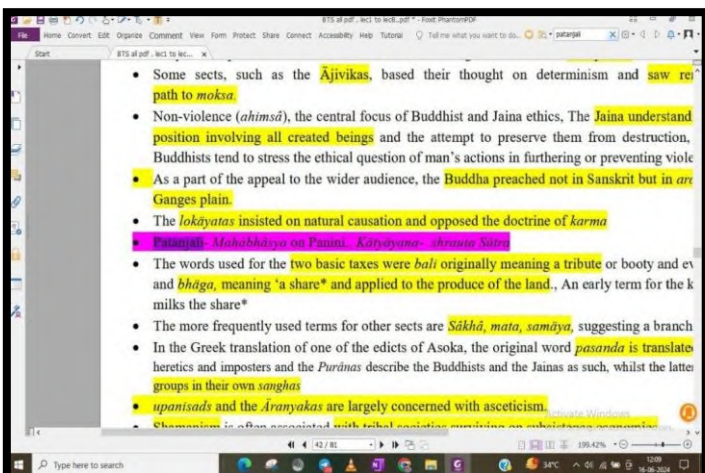
33 Which one of the following is a work attributed to playwright Bhasa?

(a) ~~Kavyalankara~~ Swapaamsha

(b) ~~Natyashastra~~ Playwright

(c) ~~Madhyama-vyayoga~~ Buddhist Tone

(d) ~~Mahabhashya~~ Ratanjali

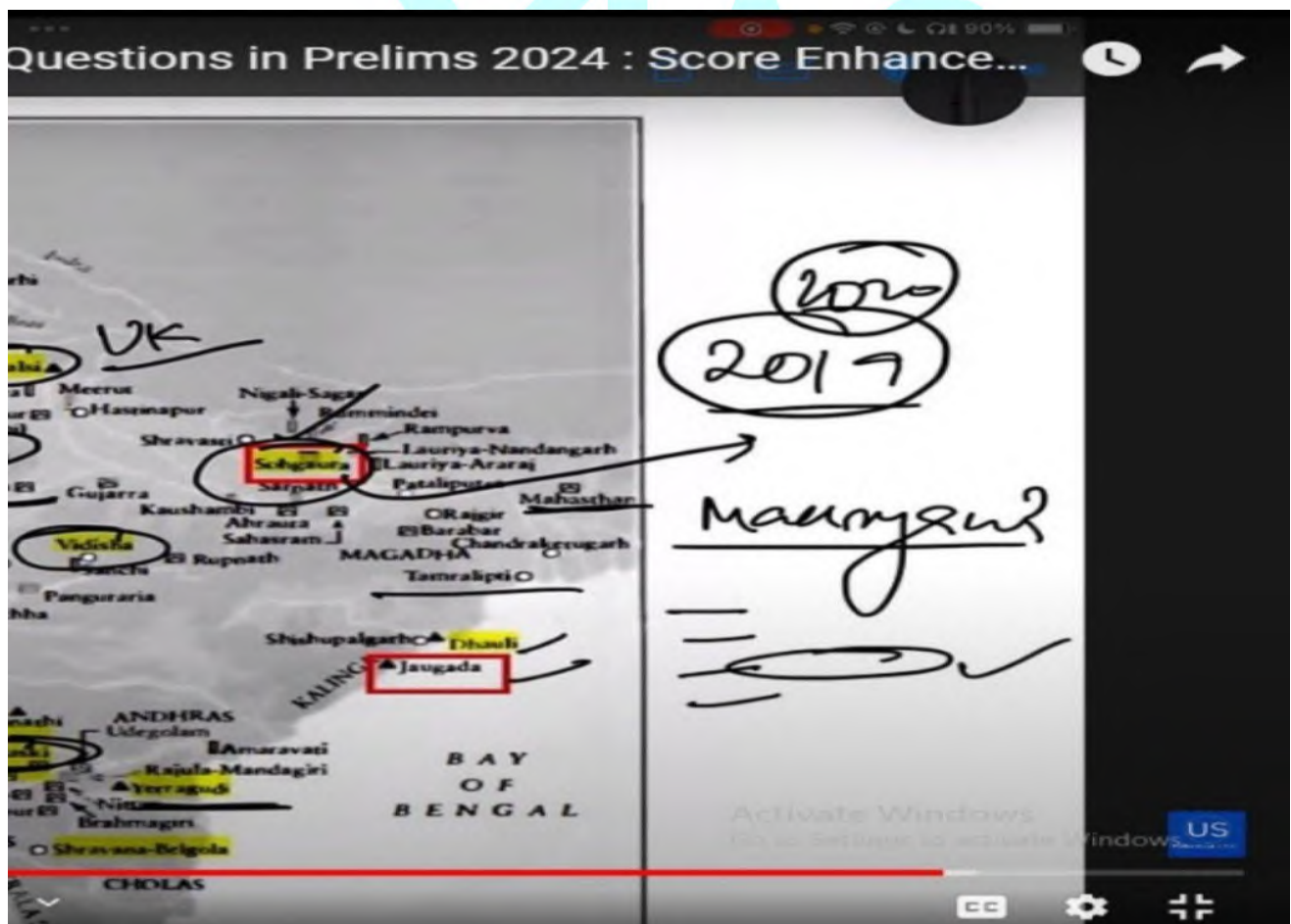
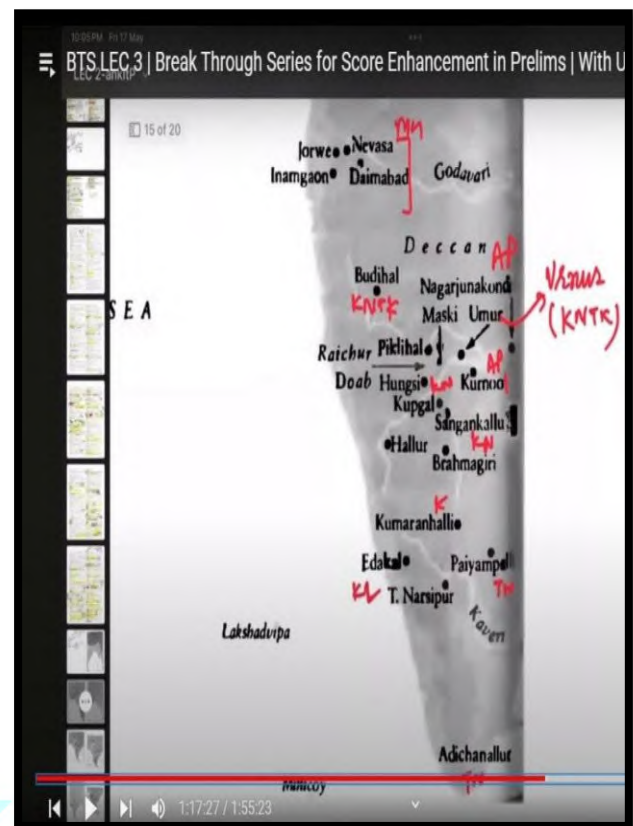


55. Consider the following information :

Archaeological Site	State	Description
1. Chandraketugarh	Odisha	Trading Port town
2. Inamgaon	Maharashtra	Chalcolithic site
3. Mangadu	Kerala	Megalithic site
4. Salihundam	Andhra Pradesh	Rock-cut cave shrines

In which of the above rows is the given information correctly matched ?

- (a) 1 and 2
 (b) 2 and 3
 (c) 3 and 4
 (d) 1 and 4

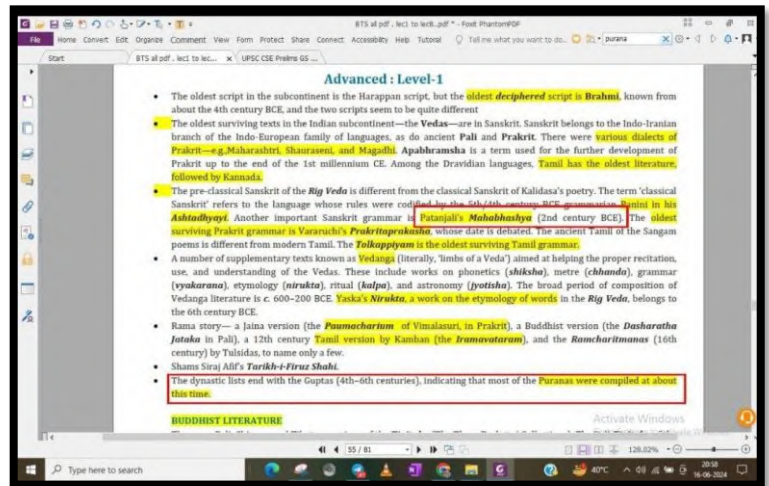


58. Consider the following statements :

1. There are no parables in Upanishads.
2. Upanishads were composed earlier than the Puranas.

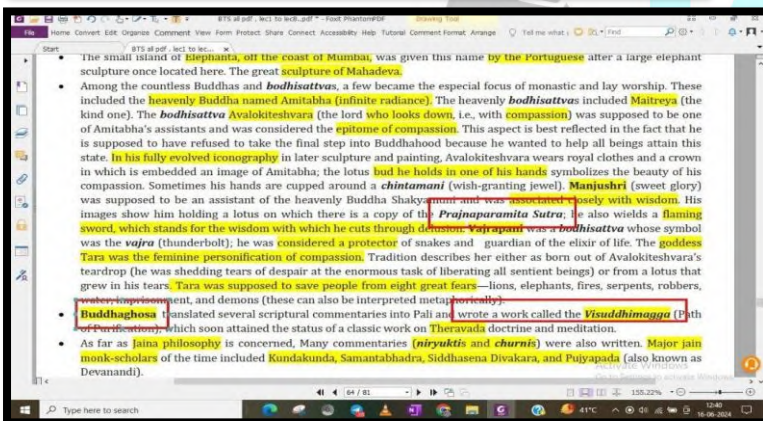
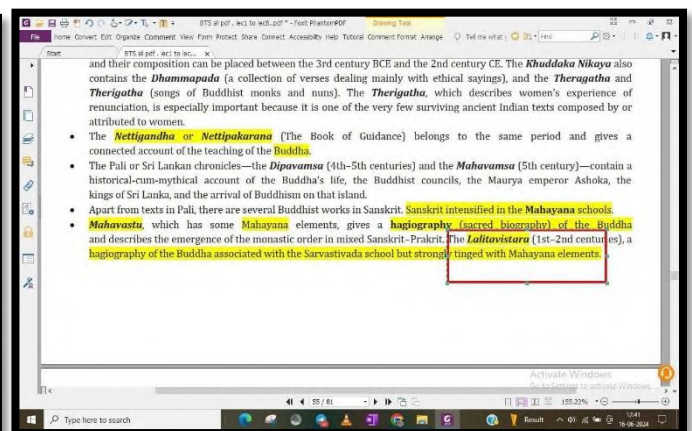
Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2



Sanghabhuti, an Indian Buddhist monk, who travelled to China at the end of the fourth century AD, was the author of a commentary on :

- (a) Prajnaparamita Sutra
- (b) Visuddhimagga
- (c) Sarvastivada Vinaya
- (d) Lalitavistara



With reference to ancient India, Gautama Buddha was generally known by which of the following epithets?

1. Nayaputta
2. Shakyamuni
3. Tathagata

Select the correct answer using the codes given below :

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 2 and 3
- (d) None of the above are epithets of Gautama Buddha

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